MODULE I: ONE WORD SUBSTITUTION

One word substitution is a process in which people use one word to replace a wordy phrase, to make the sentence structure more concise in style and clearer in meaning. It helps us in summarizing, précis writing and in all other types of official communications. Listed below are some commonly used one-word substitutes:

1. One who takes part in sports and other activities for enjoyment only:	Amateur
2. A set of equipment or tools or sometimes a machine which is used for a particular purpose:	Apparatus
3. A typical example of something:	Archetype
4. Connected with trade, collection or study of old and valuable or rare objects:	Antiquarian
5. To make a bad or unpleasant situation better:	Ameliorate
6. a word or expression from a particular subject area, that has become fashionable by being used a lot, especially on television and in the newspapers:	Buzzword
7. An ability to make money:	Bankability
8. One who does physical or unskilled work in a factory rather than office work:	Blue-collar
9. A chemical process in which substances mix with oxygen in the air to produce heat and light:	Combustion
10. Of or belonging to a college or its students:	Collegiate
11. To take equipment or weapons out of use:	Decommission
12. A person who has been appointed/selected to work on someone's behalf:	Delegate
13. A scientist who works in the field of genetic engineering:	Gengineer
14. One who thinks about himself/ herself:	Egotist
15. A statement open to more than one interpretation:	Equivocal
16. Based on what is experienced or seen rather than on theory:	Empirical
17. The main thing or person needed to support something or to make it work or happen:	Fulcrum
18. A person with showy character:	Flamboyant
19. One who does pieces of work for different organizations, rather than working all the time for a single organization:	Freelance
20. One who is easily deceived:	Gullible
21. A loud noise made by people who are angry or annoyed:	Hullabaloo
22. Consisting of parts or people which are similar to each other or are of the same type:	Homogenous
23. One who pretends to be what he/ she is not:	Hypocrite
24. Something which cannot be read:	Illegible
25. Not planned ahead of time:	Impromptu
26. Something that cannot be corrected:	Incorrigible
27. Unable to be explained or understood:	Inexplicable
28. to repeat an idea or belief frequently to someone in order to persuade them to accept it:	Indoctrinate
29. One who does not make mistakes:	Infallible
30. Something which cannot be imitated:	Inimitable
31. To examine one's thoughts and feelings:	Introspect
32. A decision that cannot be taken back:	Irrevocable
33. Detailed plan of a journey:	Itinerary
34. A confusing set of connecting passages or paths in which it is easy to get lost:	Labyrinth
35. To cause a business to close, so that its assets can be sold to pay its debts:	Liquidate
36. A speech or a performance etc made for the first time:	Maiden
37. Personal reminiscences in a narration form:	Memoir
38. One who is new to a profession	Novice
39. A word no longer in use:	Obsolete
40. One who shows too much concern for small details of learning or teaching:	Pedant
41. A situation or statement which seems impossible or is difficult to understand because it contains two opposite facts or characteristics:	Paradox
42. A business which provides goods or services:	Purveyor
43. Someone with a very great ability which usually shows itself when that person is a young child	Prodigy
44. To write under a different name:	Pseudonym
45. One who speaks less/reserved:	Reticent
46. Representation of real world by a computer program:	Simulation
47. Causing little or no damage to the environment and therefore able to continue for a long time:	Sustainable
48. A situation in which you balance two opposing situations or qualities:	Trade-off
49. A decision on which all agree:	Unanimous
50. Relating to people who do physical or unskilled work in a factory rather than office work	White-collar

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Practice Sheet
Choose the most correct option (1-25)

1. Finally, through a _____ of corridors she found his office.
A. labyrinth B. servile C. labyrinthine
D. fixture

2. After three years of heavy losses the company went into _____ with debts totaling Rs 100 million.
A. liquidate B. liquidation C. liquid
D. bankruptcy

3. There's a crowd of angry demonstrators making a _____ outside the Houses of Parliament.
A. hullabaloo B. humdrum C. uproar D. upstart

4. This theory needs to be backed up with solid _____ data/evidence.
A. upstart B. empirical C. liquid D. versatile

5. Most of the students were _____ about answering questions.
A. hesitating B. surely C. reticent D. illegible

6. It is a curious _____ that drinking a lot of water can often make you feel thirsty.
A. paradox B. antithesis C. antonym D. opposite

7. Foreign aid is badly needed to _____ the effects of the drought.
A. analyze B. liquidate C. annex D. ameliorate

8. He was an _____singer until the age of 40, when he turned professional.
A. debut B. novice C. newbie D. amateur

9. I'm not _____ enough to believe something that outrageous.
A. gullible B. freelance C. good D. nubile

10. She has written a _____ of her encounters with W.H. Auden over the years.
A. agenda B. memo C. memoir D. email

11. They have become _____, with both sides refusing to compromise any further.
A. irreconcilable B. Irrevocable C. indelible
D. verbose

12. They are demanding the _____ of ancient treasures that were removed from the country in the 16th century.
A. recall B. restitution C. reissue
D. simulation

13. The government has decided to_____two battleships.
A. simulate B. reinstitute
C. decommission D. recommission

14. He was describing, in his own _____ style/way, how to write a best-selling novel.
A. inimitable B. iniquitous C. stylistic
D. texture

15. They've taken on some financial whizzkid who's going to sort out all their problems.
A. problem B. whizzkid C. relief D. purveyor

16. Periodical publication of official news
A. Gazette B. Magazine C. Memo D. Periodical

17. That which cannot be corrected
A. Unintelligible B. Indelible C. Illegible
D. Incorrigible

18. A style in which a writer makes a display of his Knowledge.
A. Pedantic B. Verbose C. Pompous
D. Ornate

19. One who possesses many talents
A. Versatile B. Nubile C. Exceptional
D. Gifted

20. That which cannot be read
A. Negligible B. Illegible C. Ineligible
D. Incorrigible

21. Habitually silent or talking little
A. Servile B. Unequivocal C. Taciturn
D. Synoptic

22. Something which is impossible to correct
A. Incurable B. Incorrigible C. Hardened
D. Invulnerable

23. Detailed plan of a journey
A. Travelogue B. Travelkit C. Schedule
D. Itinerary

24. A person who is not experienced in a job or situation
A. Novice B. Newbie C. Entrepreneur
D. Debut

25. To (cause to) change to suit different conditions of life, weather, etc.
A. Adapt B. Adopt C. Accustom
D. Acclimatise

Match Column A with Column B (26-30)

	Column A	Column B
26.	Inexplicable	Impeccable
27.	Veteran	Enigmatic
28.	Improbable	Experienced
29.	Impromptu	Unpremeditated
30.	Infallible	Preposterous